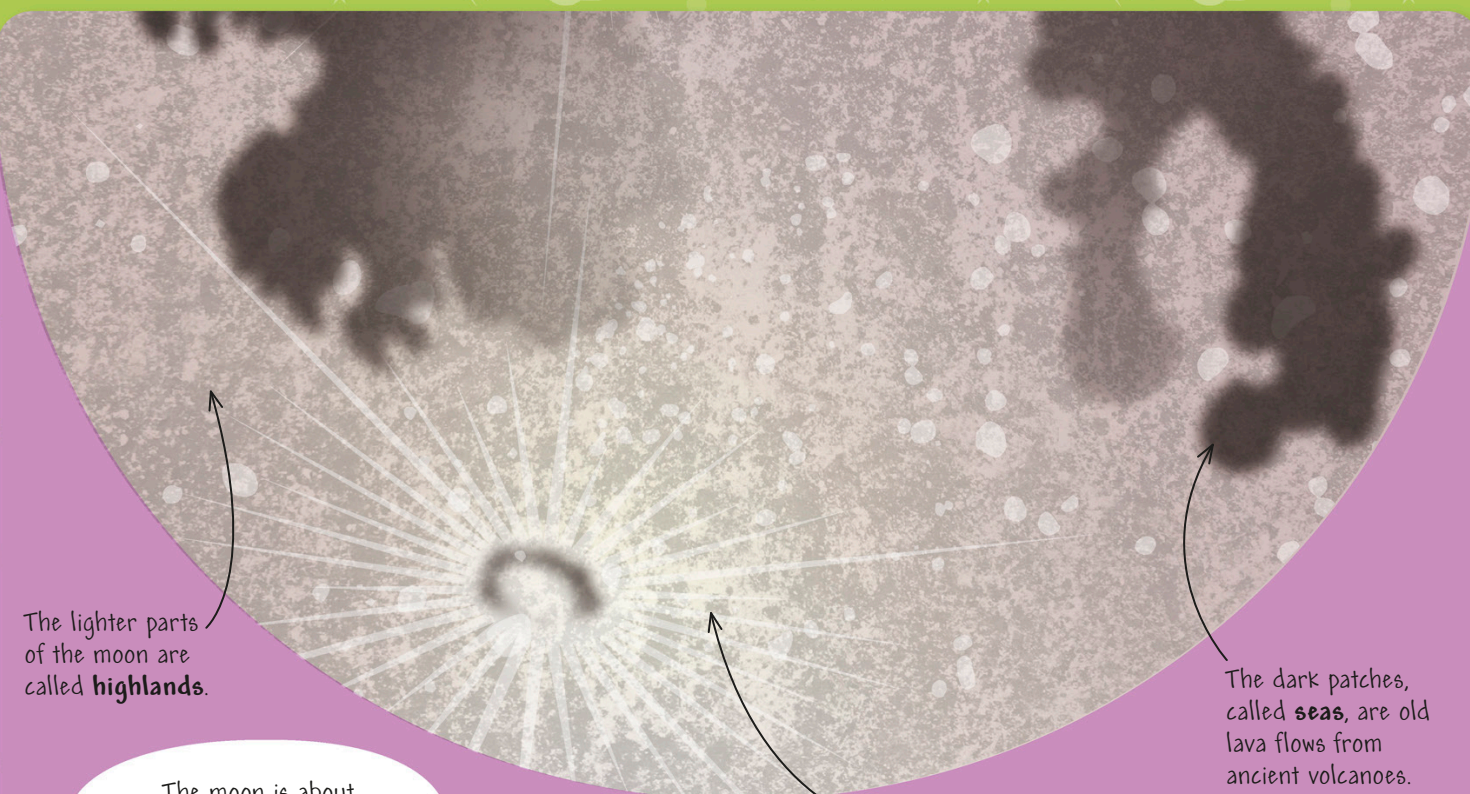




The lighter parts of the moon are called **highlands**.

The moon is about one-quarter the size of the Earth.



The dark patches, called **seas**, are old lava flows from ancient volcanoes.

Craters show where space rocks called **asteroids** smashed into the moon a long time ago.

The moon

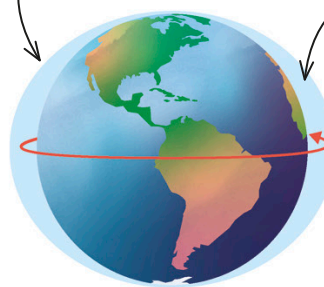
The moon is a dry, dusty, airless world. It **orbits**, or travels around, Earth as the pair whiz around the sun. The moon looks bright in the night sky because it reflects light from the sun.

Tides

The moon's **gravity** is a pulling force that tugs on the ocean. This creates a bulge in the sea on either side of the Earth. We call these bulges high tides. As Earth spins, the tides move around the planet.

The ocean also bulges on the opposite side of the Earth.

The ocean bulges where the moon's gravity is strongest.



Pull of moon's gravity



Moon

Earth

Between high tides there are low tides, where the water level falls.